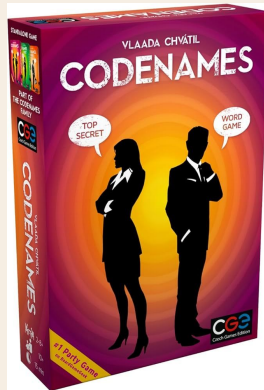
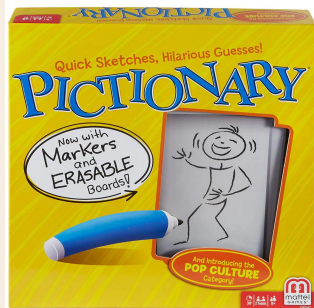


Game Project Process

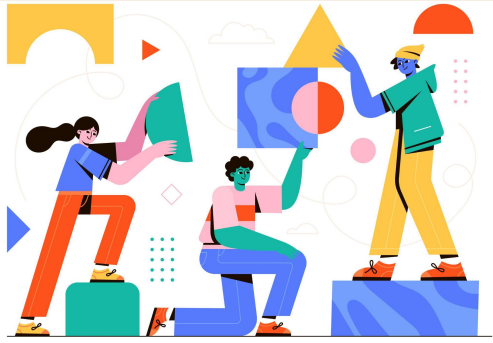
By: Ryan Menzildjian

When I started brainstorming for the project I immediately went for something competitive and fast paced. Someone that will allow competition between others while also be educational in the realm of design. Since I had recently played the game Codenames online with friends I decided that would be the perfect jumping off point. I then decided it might be a good idea to integrate the game pictictionary as well.

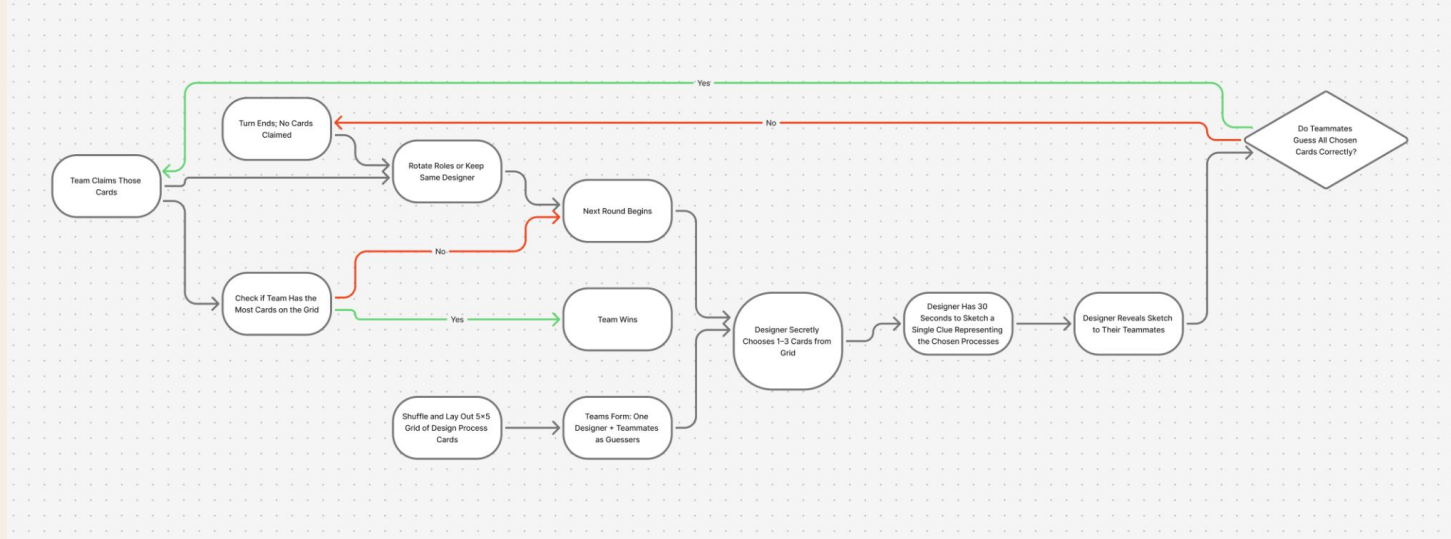


Development Period

I developed the idea that I wanted the player to guess from Client Concept Cards (e.g. designing a community park or an app for seniors). However, after brief critique, we found that to be out of the scope of the project as it did not introduce or include the processes of design. So I pivoted my idea to where the teammate has to guess the design processes used within the sketch which will teach the players to be more familiarized with different types of design processes and ideas. I began digitally sketching logo for the game itself which I soon named Brief Cipher, as if the teammate must decipher the sketch of the lead designer. I decided to go for a minimalistic style as its very design oriented and is a good representation of what the game is about. I wanted to go for a fun style so I took reference from the corporate memphis design style.



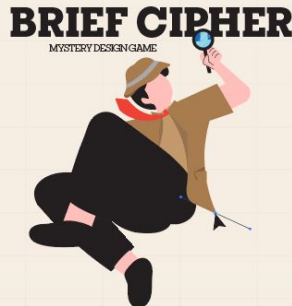
Development Period



Here I have my diagram which I used to map out how the game would work and what would be the required items for the actual game. This also helped me with figuring out the functionality of the game and whether it would work or not or if there was a point in the game that didn't make sense and stop the game entirely.

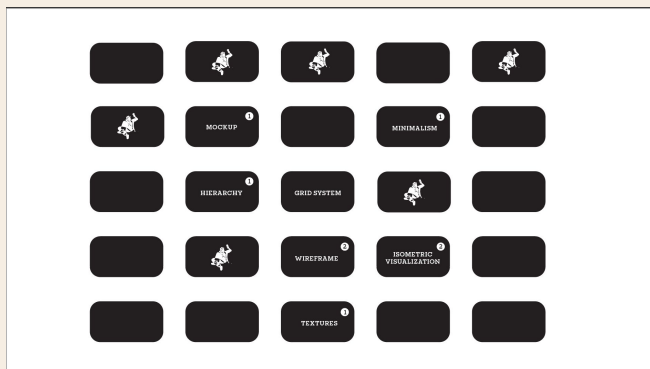
Development Period - 2

As you can see I used a typeface named Elizeth, from adobe fonts. Again, I found it to be a good representation as it's not boring as a game should be, however, it maintains the minimalist, organized, and blocky style that represents graphic design. I found the logo and typeface coupled together worked well. The colors I kept as temporary as they weren't totally meshed well together so I decided to test an alternative logo style and color to emphasize the character more. However, I felt like this did not pop out as well as I thought and nobody would buy the game by looking at the basic logo itself. So I finally decided to just mesh the two ideas together and use black with the other elements of the original logo and I think it works well and allowed me to have freedom with my color palette.



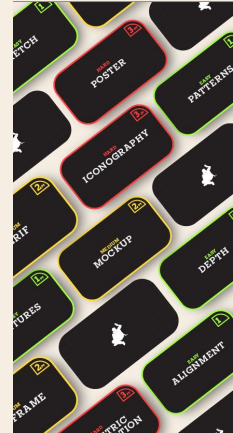
Development Period - 3

I then began sketching the cards themselves. They would include the name of the process as well as a point value. Again, maintaining the minimalistic style so in addition to the basic black I was using earlier as well as rounded corners for the cards, I decided that for the back of the card it would be a solid color version of the logo. This originally felt like it worked well however after looking over multiple days I felt as though it was bland and uninviting, despite the clarity. So I wanted something that had clear contrast while also being inviting and easy to pop out.



Critique Period

At this point it was the critique period so my colleagues would test the game and see if it was functional and a fun idea. This was very helpful because it made me realize not everyone will understand the terminology of every design process and made the game basically unplayable if the cards originally started facing down, so I pivoted and made it so the cards would face up. Also another issue was the clarity of the cards so I decided to make clear categorization on the scoring as well as what cards are a higher risk to use. With this I decided to create mockups for the cards almost from scratch as the cards I had were not traditional dimensions.



Development Period - 4

Now that I have the cards done I decided to make the pamphlet that would read the games instructions. I went with a trifold style since the game was simple and would be nicely organized within just 3 folds. I started with creating small funky doodle designs that complimented the logos style as well. This was the original idea which was going to be placed on the back of the box but after further thought I felt it might be better organized within a product of its own. So I simply divided up the 3 sections and made an interesting mockup from it.

1



2



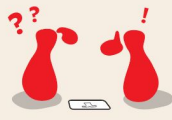
3



4



5



6



HOW

1

shuffle the deck



4

Choose the Lead Designer.

- ☐ NO DESIGN TEAM
- ☒ DESIGNER LEADERSHIP



You are responsible for choosing cards from the grid. Then create a design that utilizes all the elements you've chosen.

TO

2

Lay a 5x5 grid



5

Time to Guess



Your teammates must now guess what design process(es) we've used for its creation.

PLAY

3

Split into teams



6

You are the WINNER



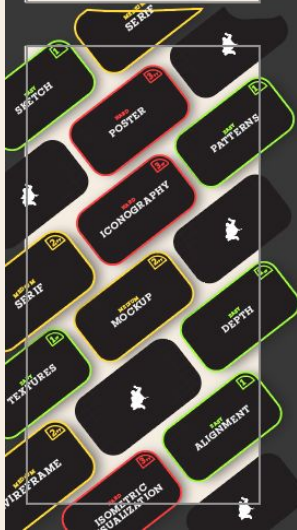
The team with the most points are declared the winner!

BRIEF CIPHER

MYSTERY DESIGN GAME



4-8 PLAYERS



Finishing Up

I was now happy with the way everything turned out so I decided to transition to the rest of the mockups. However I was wondering if maybe I should have turned my game into a web version so that impacted deciding on what mockups I would use. However I found that it would make more sense if I created a physical version so to differentiate from the game that inspired this one, and also It allowed me to play with a larger variety of mockups. I continued with the main box which I created a simple design that was also represented on the cards so it made visual sense and also stuck with the color scheme of the game. I originally wanted to make a pattern but I thought it would look to basic and cluttered for my minimalist style so I went for an organized grid instead. I finally did the same for the cards box and put the logo on the dry erase board.

